

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF BRONX

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TYREEK MOORE,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER LUILLY  
VARGAS, Shield No. 6585, SERGEANT BRIAN  
QUERY, and POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOES #1-10  
(names and number of whom are unknown at present),

Defendants.

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**SUMMONS**

Index No.:

The Basis of Venue is:

Location of Incident

Plaintiff designates Bronx  
County as the place of trial.

**To the above named Defendants:**

**You are hereby summoned** to answer the verified complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York  
January 24, 2018

Yours, etc.

\_\_\_\_\_  
/s/  
JACOBS & HAZAN, LLP.  
STUART E. JACOBS, ESQ.  
Attorney for Plaintiff  
30 Vesey Street, 4<sup>th</sup> Floor  
New York, New York 10007  
(212) 577-2690

TO: City of New York, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007  
POLICE OFFICER LUILLY VARGAS, Shield No. 6585, Narcotics Borough Bronx,  
One Police Plaza, New York, NY 10038  
SERGEANT BRIAN QUERY, Narcotics Borough Bronx, One Police Plaza, New York,  
NY 10038

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF BRONX

----- X

TYREEK MOORE,

Plaintiff,

**INDEX NO.:**

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER LUILLY  
VARGAS, Shield No. 6585, SERGEANT BRIAN  
QUERY, and POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOES #1-10  
(names and number of whom are unknown at present),

**JURY TRIAL DEMANDED**

Defendants.

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Plaintiff TYREEK MOORE, by his attorneys, Jacobs & Hazan, LLP, as and for his  
Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

**PRELIMINARY STATEMENT**

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the First, Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On November 2, 2016, at approximately 6:00 a.m., plaintiff Tyreek Moore was lawfully present inside of his apartment located at 919 Bruckner Boulevard, Basement Apartment, Bronx, NY, when the defendant police officers unlawfully entered the apartment with their guns drawn and pointed at plaintiff, without probable cause or any legal justification. The defendant police officers unlawfully searched, seized, unlawfully handcuffed, falsely imprisoned and falsely arrested plaintiff without probable cause or any legal justification to believe plaintiff committed a crime or violated the law in any manner. The defendants transported plaintiff against his will to the 41<sup>st</sup> precinct. Thereafter, the defendants denied plaintiff the right to due process and a fair trial until all charges against plaintiff were dismissed and sealed on May 2, 2017. Plaintiff was deprived of his constitutional and common law rights when the individual defendants unlawfully searched, confined, arrested, imprisoned, and denied his rights to a fair trial and due process in violation of the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution.

## **PARTIES**

2. Plaintiff TYREEK MOORE is and was at all times relevant herein a resident of the State of New York.

3. POLICE OFFICER LUILLY VARGAS, Shield No. 6585, is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

4. POLICE OFFICER LUILLY VARGAS, Shield No. 6585, is and was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the Bronx Gang Squad.

5. POLICE OFFICER LUILLY VARGAS, Shield No. 6585, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

6. SERGEANT BRIAN QUERY is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

7. SERGEANT BRIAN QUERY was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the Bronx Gang Squad.

8. SERGEANT BRIAN QUERY is being sued in his individual and official capacity

9. New York City Police Officers John Does #1-10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.

10. Police Officers John Does #1-10 are being sued in his individual and official capacities.

11. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in he as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.

12. At all times relevant hereto, defendant CITY OF NEW YORK, operated, maintained managed, supervised and controlled the New York City Police Department ("NYPD") as part of and in conjunction with its municipal function.

13. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police

force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.

14. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the CITY OF NEW YORK, in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50.

15. The CITY OF NEW YORK conducted a hearing pursuant to 50-h of the general municipal law on or about October 16, 2017.

16. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and THE CITY OF NEW YORK has failed to pay or adjust the claim.

17. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

18. Plaintiff sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

### **STATEMENT OF FACTS**

19. On November 2, 2016, at approximately 6:00 a.m., plaintiff was lawfully present inside of his apartment located at 919 Bruckner Boulevard, Basement Apartment, Bronx, New York.

20. On November 2, 2016, at approximately 6:00 a.m., the defendant police officers unlawfully entered 919 Bruckner Boulevard, Basement Apartment, Bronx, NY and searched the apartment and the individuals present.

21. At no time relevant herein did defendants recover any illegal drugs, weapons, or contraband from plaintiff's person, or from a location that was in plaintiff's possession, custody, or control.

22. At no time relevant herein did plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law in any manner, nor did the defendant officers have probable cause to believe he committed a crime or violated the law.

23. Nevertheless, plaintiff was unlawfully handcuffed, arrested, and transported against his will to the 41<sup>st</sup> Precinct where he detained in a filthy holding cell for many hours.

24. On the afternoon of November 2, 2016, plaintiff was transported from the 41<sup>st</sup> Precinct to Bronx Central Booking, searched, and placed in a holding cell.

25. The defendant police officers intentionally provided the Bronx County District Attorney's Office with false, misleading and incomplete information regarding their basis for arresting and prosecuting plaintiff and falsely charged plaintiff with crimes he did not commit.

26. Based upon the false, misleading and/or incomplete information provided to the District Attorney's Office by the defendant police officers, a prosecution was initiated against plaintiff.

27. On November 3, 2016 at approximately 12:00 p.m., after approximately 30 hours in unlawful custody, plaintiff was arraigned in Bronx Criminal Court, charged with crimes he did not commit was released.

28. Plaintiff was unlawfully charged with Criminal Possession of a Controlled Substance in the Seventh Degree and Criminally Using Drug Paraphernalia in the Second Degree.

29. Thereafter, on May 2, 2017, all charges against plaintiff were dismissed and sealed in their entirety.

30. As a result of the false arrest of plaintiff, plaintiff sustained significant property damage including damage to his front door, kitchen and cabinets. Additionally, numerous pieces of plaintiff's property including clothes were stolen from plaintiff's apartment during the course of his arrest.

31. As a result of the false arrest of plaintiff, plaintiff was evicted from his apartment.

32. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent the unjustifiable search, seizure, false arrest, and denial of the right to due process/ fair trial against plaintiff.

33. The unlawful search, false arrest/imprisonment, denial of a right to fair trial against plaintiff by the individually named defendants caused plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological and emotional trauma.

### **FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth Amendment, Fifth Amendment and Fourteenth Amendment Rights**

34. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 33 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

35. The individually named police officer defendants while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused plaintiff to be unlawfully seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned, denied of his right to fair trial and maliciously prosecuted without probable cause in violation of plaintiff's right to be free of unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States, denial of his right to due process under the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free of deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

36. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

## **SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION**

### **False Arrest and False Imprisonment**

37. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 36 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

38. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine plaintiff and, in fact, confined plaintiff, and plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

39. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

40. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

## **THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION**

### **Unlawful Search**

41. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 40 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

42. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and search employed by defendants herein terminated plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

43. Defendants lacked probable cause to search plaintiff and his apartment.

44. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

45. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

#### **FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

##### **Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress**

46. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 45 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

47. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to plaintiff, Tyreek Moore. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to plaintiff and violated plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

48. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff was deprived of liberty and sustained great emotional injuries.

49. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

#### **FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

##### **Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision**

50. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 49 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

51. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

## **SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

### **Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process**

52. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 51 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

53. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Bronx County District Attorney's Office.

54. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Bronx County District Attorney's Office.

55. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Bronx County District Attorney's Office.

56. In withholding/creating false evidence against plaintiff Tyreek Moore, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, defendants violated plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free to deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

57. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff Tyreek Moore, sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, lost earnings and deprivation of his constitutional rights.

58. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

59. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

60. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.



**SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION****Failure to Intervene**

61. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 60 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

62. Defendants had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

63. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

64. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear of his safety, and he was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.

65. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

**JURY DEMAND**

66. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

**PRAYER FOR RELIEF**

**WHEREFORE**, plaintiff Tyreek Moore demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law. That the plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorneys fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

Dated: New York, New York  
January 24, 2018

By: \_\_\_\_\_/s/

STUART E. JACOBS  
DAVID M. HAZAN  
JACOBS & HAZAN, LLP  
Attorneys for Plaintiff  
30 Vesey Street, 4<sup>th</sup> Floor  
New York, NY 10007  
(212) 577-2690

TO: City of New York, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007  
POLICE OFFICER LUILLY VARGAS, Shield No. 6585, Narcotics Borough Bronx,  
One Police Plaza, New York, NY 10038  
SERGEANT BRIAN QUERY, Narcotics Borough Bronx, One Police Plaza, New York,  
NY 10038

**ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION**

**STUART E. JACOBS**, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a partner of the law firm of **JACOBS & HAZAN, LLP**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe he to be true. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is that Plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York  
January 24, 2018

/s/  
STUART E. JACOBS